They have survived natural dangers for millions of years. But, sadly, human activities during the last few decades have put them in grave danger. There are many factors that threaten their survival. People hunt them for their meat or collect their eggs. Sometimes they are accidentally trapped in the nests of motorboats. Problems like pollution, dumping of plastics into the ocean and construction activities on nesting beaches also hurt their survival. Only by systematically tackling these problems, and removing these threats, can we ensure that sea turtles will continue to exist in the years to come.

Shekar Dattatri

Shekar Dattatri writes popular articles on wildlife, conservation and film making. He has been interested in nature from childhood. He is an award-winning wildlife and conservation filmmaker. For more information on him visit www.shekardattatri.com

Fill in the table given below.

S. No	Problems faced by the hatchlings	Effect	Solution
1.	Pollution	Survival of sea turtles becomes difficult.	Reduce the usage of plastics.
2.	Predators		
3.	Human Activities		

GLOSSARY

survive - continue to live
mysteries - facts that are difficult to understand
fascinating - attracting greatly
decade - a period of ten years

READ AND UNDERSTAND

A. Choose the correct answers. You may choose more than one answer if needed.

1. The _____ is a biological relative of tortoises.
   a. sea turtle
   b. fish
   c. reptile
2. In India's coastal waters we can see a species of _____.
   a. tortoises
   b. sea turtles
   c. dolphin

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